

How to make neurodivergent people love you?

Firebird

People struggle.

We look at it with the lens of struggle.

Sensitivity redid the attention to this is autism

impulsive distracted cry from novelty hyperactive this is ADHD

Executive dysfunctions emotional dysregulation this is AUDHD

Inclusive designers

Involve them people with autism ADHD and AUDHD

involve them

Ask listen act on what you hear ask more

Don't make assumptions

These people are canaries in the UX coal mine

They will identify the issues faster.

Use clear information good for everyone see picture

set clear expectation

Before they start engaging and after they have finished the task

Enable us to choose what works for us.

It is not if there is no enthusiasm for the task it's a problem enthusiasm for task is very important.

Designed for messy people

Involve neuro divergent.

Sex expectation.

Allow people to choose.

Designed for messy people

Respect your users.

How to be a supportive colleague.

Help to get basic needs.

Value us.

Valuable

Be generous.

Plan of the talk.

One about neurodiversity

To how to make neurodivergent people love your designs

Three, how to make neuro divergent people love you in parentheses just as a friend

Here's a clear and thoughtful summary of your notes from the talk titled:

How to Make Neurodivergent People Love You

Core Idea: Firebird Metaphor

- Neurodivergent people often struggle—not because they are broken, but because systems aren’t designed for their needs.
 - Society tends to view neurodivergence through a lens of **struggle**, which frames differences like autism and ADHD as deficiencies rather than variations.
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Understanding Neurodivergence

Key Neurotypes Mentioned:

- **Autism** → Heightened sensitivity, need for clarity, preference for predictability.
 - **ADHD** → Impulsivity, hyperactivity, novelty-seeking, distractibility.
 - **AuDHD (Autism + ADHD)** → Executive dysfunction, emotional dysregulation.
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Design Principles for Inclusion

Inclusive Design Starts With People

- Involve neurodivergent users early and often:
- **Ask, listen, act on what you hear, then ask again.**
- Avoid assumptions—treat each person as the expert of their own experience.

UX Coal Mine Analogy:

- Neurodivergent users are like **canaries in the UX coal mine**:
 - They spot design issues earlier and more sharply than neurotypical users.
 - Designing well for them improves UX for *everyone*.
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Practical UX Guidelines

- **Use clear and structured information** (visuals help everyone).
- **Set clear expectations:**
- Before users engage and after they complete a task.
- **Offer choices:**
- Let users select formats, workflows, or interactions that work best for them.
- **Design for “messy people”:**
- Embrace imperfection and variability in user behavior.

Being a Supportive Colleague

- Support neurodivergent colleagues in their **basic needs** (e.g. space, quiet, clarity).
- Show respect and **value their contributions**.
- Be generous with time, feedback, and patience.

Takeaways by Talk Structure:

1. **Understanding neurodiversity** – shifting from pathologizing to empowering.
2. **How to make neurodivergent people love your designs** – clarity, choice, flexibility.
3. **How to make neurodivergent people love you** (even just as a friend) – be kind, be curious, be respectful.

Let me know if you'd like a visual summary or turn this into a slide or one-pager.